know even the basic court judgements on the basis of which their duties were to be performed. They also did not have any information about the rules. But then, wasn't it to be expected?'

These men had been taken into the service and immediately put on the job. The same pressures must have existed then as they did during her tenure, namely, a shortage of staff. Kiran Bedi put events in perspective:

> So, there was no law training. No correctional training. No knowledge whatsoever of the Prison Act. The only time a person read the Prison Manual was when there was an inquiry instituted against him.
>
> There was no way I could compromise on this. A modicum of training just had to be imparted to them, otherwise our effort would have been an absolute non-starter.
>
> So, we commenced a two weeks' course. One hour each day. The staff gets about two to two-and-a-half hours' free time in the afternoons during the prisoners' lock-up duration. That's when they can go home and spend some time with their families. It is from this time that I took an hour. I knew it was hard on them, but then what could I do?
>
> Initially there was a lot of disgruntlement because of their scepticism. What could we tell them about prison training, they thought. We were no experts in the field. But soon they realized how little they knew about the situation they were in. They realized that they were acting only as security men, whereas their true role was that of time managers and correctional staff.
>
> The feedback I got was a desire for more of this training. And they did not want it condensed into a two-week course. They wanted it to be more expansive, more detailed and more spread over. So then we chalked out a longer course. The two-week course is now spread over four months, of an hour-long lecture per day.
>
> We have a Jail Manual, but even that does not specify what an assistant superintendent's duties are. Today they are engaged in a plethora of duties which they do only because they feel someone has to do them. Nothing in the rule book binds them to it, or suggests what they can and should do.
>
> They are now doing medical duties, canteen duties, and also handling education of the convict section. They are involved in welfare measures like running a legal section, and the hospital section, and in PRO duties. What in effect they are doing is learning their duties on the job. Obviously, there is no streamlining. So, that's what we had to do. We had to list out their duties, regularize them, and document them for posterity.
>
> Yes, that's how we worked on a new, purposeful and more effective Jail Manual so that our successors will not have to go through all that we did to bring about a touch of humaneness to the prison.

A system of *participatory management* had been evolved in Tihar and the inmates were more than willing participants in it. The superintendent of Jail 2, Tarseem Kumar, elaborated upon this programme: 'We have worked out a system of panchayats to aid us in our effort towards improving the quality of time the prisoners spend here. We have a cultural panchayat, a mess panchayat, an education panchayat and the prisoners do not find it at all uncomfortable to follow as this system is very indigenous to our country. A large portion of the problems, which are mostly minor administrative problems, are resolved and sorted out at these panchayats by the prisoners themselves. This has taken a big load off us.'

Jail 3 had its own academic council, which looked after the various educational, vocational and